

Codebook

Themes (3) **bolded**, underlined, and CAPITALISED. Top-level categories (9) **bolded**.

[Square brackets] indicates an non-codeable parent category, i.e., no data was directly coded into here and instead acts as a container for the lower hierarchical categories.

Below is a list view, followed by a full breakdown of each category's description and examples.

1 NARRATIONAL

1.1 [Settings]

1.1.1 [Natural World]

1.1.1.1 Creatures

1.1.1.2 Terrains

1.1.1.3 Vegetation

1.1.1.4 Sky and Space

1.1.1.5 Water Features

1.1.1.6 Weather

1.1.2 Fictional and Spiritual Settings

1.1.3 Societal Places

1.1.4 Named Regional Places

1.1.5 Scene Qualities

1.1.6 Spatial Orientation

1.2 [Characters]

1.2.1 [Character Descriptors]

1.2.1.1 [Outfit Details]

1.2.1.1.1 Accessories

1.2.1.1.2 Hair

1.2.1.1.3 Outfit Descriptors

1.2.1.2 Identity

1.2.1.3 Professions and Pursuits

1.2.1.3.1 Music-related Professions and Pursuits

1.2.1.4 Relations

1.2.1.5 Archetypes

1.2.1.6 Social Collectives

1.2.1.7 Traits

1.2.2 [Named Figures]

1.2.2.1 Creators

1.2.2.2 Fictional Characters

1.2.2.3 Historical and Mythical Figures

1.2.2.4 Performers and Entertainers

1.2.3 [Social Presence]

1.2.3.1 Solitude

1.2.3.2 Dyads

1.2.3.3 Groups

1.2.4 Body Parts

1.3 [Objects & Things]

1.3.1 Consumables

1.3.2 Everyday Objects

1.3.3 Transport

1.3.4 Commerce and Organisations

1.3.5 Materials and Surfaces

1.3.6 Object Qualities

1.4 [Actions]

1.4.1 [Agentic Actions]

1.4.1.1 Directed Movement

1.4.1.2 Daily life

1.4.1.3 Music-linked Movement

1.4.1.4 Sports

1.4.1.5 Creating and Performing

1.4.1.6 Relational and Social

1.4.1.7 Consuming

1.4.1.8 Conflict and Wrongdoing

1.4.2 [Processes and States]

1.4.2.1 Perceptual acts

1.4.2.2 Non-directional Motions

- 1.4.2.3 Rest and Leisure
- 1.4.2.4 Transforming and Learning
- 1.4.2.5 Waiting and Anticipating
- 1.4.3 [Action Modifiers]
 - 1.4.3.1 Speed
 - 1.4.3.2 Characterisation

2 REFERENTIAL

2.1 [Music & Sounds]

- 2.1.1 Instruments, Ensembles, and Imitations
- 2.1.2 Music Use and Function
- 2.1.3 Sound Qualities
 - 2.1.3.1 Music Genre, Cultural, and Stylistic Labels
 - 2.1.3.2 Technical and Structural Music Elements
- 2.1.4 Playback and Listening Devices
- 2.1.5 Named Artists and Musicians
- 2.1.6 Named Songs and Lyrics
- 2.1.7 Sounds and Sound Effects

2.2 [Media, Art, & Technology]

- 2.2.1 Media Formats
- 2.2.2 Media Genres and Styles
- 2.2.3 Media Packaging Structures
- 2.2.4 Media Techniques and Effects
- 2.2.5 Music and Sound in Media
- 2.2.6 Media Companies and Devices
- 2.2.7 Digital Platforms and Applications
- 2.2.8 Named Media References

2.3 [Chronology & Events]

- 2.3.1 Events and Occasions
- 2.3.2 Historical Events and Periods
- 2.3.3 Narrative Progression
- 2.3.4 Passage and Repetition of Time
- 2.3.5 Seasons and Time

3 EXPERIENTIAL

3.1 [Symbolic & Sensory Representations]

3.1.1 [Sensory Details]

3.1.1.1 [Visual Details]

3.1.1.1.1 Colour

3.1.1.1.2 Illumination

3.1.1.1.3 Text

3.1.1.1.4 Vantage Point

3.1.1.1.5 Oddities, Effects, Shapes, Patterns

3.1.1.2 Smell

3.1.1.3 Bodily Sensation

3.1.2 Conceptual and Metaphorical References

3.2 [Subjective & Personal Experience]

3.2.1 Emotions and Affective States

3.2.2 Opinions and Preferences

3.2.3 Personal Significance

3.2.4 Personal Time-linked Connections

1 NARRATIONAL

1.1 [Settings]

DESCRIPTION:

The landscapes, locations, and atmospheres described — spanning real-world places, imagined worlds, natural environments, and the qualities and aesthetics of a scene.

1.1.1 [Natural World]

DESCRIPTION:

Non-human and non-built environments, encompassing flora, fauna, landforms, weather, and celestial phenomena.

1.1.1.1 Creatures

DESCRIPTION:

real, mythological, or fantastical creatures and any descriptions of them.

EXAMPLES:

dogs, centaur, dinosaurs, dragon, unicorn, rabbit-like creature, fluffy, scary, vicious, tame, wild

1.1.1.2 Terrains

DESCRIPTION:

physical formations of geographic and natural landscape features of the Earth's surface.

EXAMPLES:

canyons, desert, tundra, rolling hills, forest, prairie, mountains, valleys

1.1.1.3 Vegetation

DESCRIPTION:

flora and plant life, in natural or symbolic contexts.

EXAMPLES:

wildflowers, palm trees, wheat, weeping willow, roses, ivy

1.1.1.4 Sky and Space

DESCRIPTION:

celestial, cosmic, or atmospheric elements above or beyond Earth.

EXAMPLES:

clouds, sun, sunrise, moon, stars, moonlight, aurora borealis, galaxies, black holes

1.1.1.5 Water Features

DESCRIPTION:

bodies of water, water-related natural features, and aquatic phenomena.

EXAMPLES:

rivers, ocean, pond, underwater, waves, rapids

1.1.1.6 Weather

DESCRIPTION:

atmospheric and seasonal weather conditions shaping the environment.

EXAMPLES:

rainfall, fog, snowy, stormy, wind

1.1.2 Fictional and Spiritual Settings

DESCRIPTION:

invented or otherworldly locations from fantasy, myth, science fiction, dystopian imagination, or spiritual and symbolic realms.

EXAMPLES:

enchanted forest, far away land, virtual world, futuristic city, alien world, post-apocalyptic scene, heaven, hell, otherworldly

1.1.3 Societal Places

DESCRIPTION:

constructed, inhabited, or socially oriented settings — from private domestic spaces to public venues, institutions, infrastructures, and culturally significant sites.

EXAMPLES:

kitchen, garage, yard, my grandma's house, pub, cafe, nightclub, stadium, theatre, spa, school, office, hospital, factory, airport, highway, subway station, roads, bridge, cathedral, temple, monastery

1.1.4 Named Regional Places

DESCRIPTION:

specific, named real-world locations at any geographic scale — from landmarks and venues to cities, countries, and continents.

EXAMPLES:

Times Square, White Cliffs of Dover, Studio 54, Stubb's Bar-B-Q, Sahara, Monument Valley, Amazon Rainforest, Italy, Liverpool, New York, Asia, Latin America

1.1.5 Scene Qualities

DESCRIPTION:

the mood, tone, aesthetic, and stylistic feel of a setting, as well as its perceived scale or density.

EXAMPLES:

dreary, serene, ominous, romantic, mysterious; vast, crowded, small, deserted; dreamy, filmic, trippy, aesthetic of ..., French (when describing the aesthetic of a place)

1.1.6 Spatial Orientation

DESCRIPTION:

the concrete placement or perspective of people and things in a scene, often relative to the viewer or narrator.

EXAMPLES:

above me, beside her, around us, in the distance, out a door

1.2 [Characters]

DESCRIPTION:

References to all real and fictional people, named and not named, including descriptions such as identity, traits, appearance, roles, relations, and amount of people.

1.2.1 [Character Descriptors]

DESCRIPTION:

Ways people are described as individuals or types, through identity markers, roles, traits, clothing, or social groups.

1.2.1.1 [Outfit Details]

DESCRIPTION:

References to clothing, style, and presentation through dress.

1.2.1.1.1 Accessories

DESCRIPTION:

wearable items that are not primary clothing.

EXAMPLES:

hat, necklace, gloves, leg warmers, sunglasses

1.2.1.1.2 Hair

DESCRIPTION:

references to hair styles, textures, lengths, colours, and other distinctive features of hair.

EXAMPLES:

afro, red head, curly, blonde, bald

1.2.1.1.3 Outfit Descriptors

DESCRIPTION:

outfit descriptors including style, aesthetic, era, pattern, and condition, without being outfit pieces themselves.

EXAMPLES:

dress, tshirt, trousers, pants, shoes, 80s, casual, funky, fancy, formal, gothic, ragged, retro

1.2.1.2 Identity

DESCRIPTION:

labels for social categories, backgrounds, and collective identities.

EXAMPLES:

African Americans, Arabic, female, gay, white, youth, Gen-X, yuppies, aristocrats, bikers, punks, hippies, metal heads, rockers, beatniks

1.2.1.3 Professions and Pursuits

DESCRIPTION:

roles tied to occupation, labour, hobbies, or performance identities.

EXAMPLES:

actor, dancer, detective, bartender, cowboy, soldier, scientist, stripper, trucker, TikTokker, athlete, farmer, monk

1.2.1.3.1 Music-related Professions and Pursuits

DESCRIPTION:

sub-category of “Professions and Pursuits” for the code density of music-related references.

EXAMPLES:

guitarist, drummer, choir director, singer, producer

1.2.1.4 Relations

DESCRIPTION:

references to familial, romantic, or friendship ties that situate individuals in relation to others through kinship or close social bonds.

EXAMPLES:

mom, dad, siblings, grandma, grandparents, friends, mates,

1.2.1.5 Archetypes

DESCRIPTION:

stock figures, genre roles, symbolic character types, and functional roles in narratives or myths.

EXAMPLES:

heroine, villain, femme fatale, prince charming, spy, killer, antagonist, final boss

1.2.1.6 Social Collectives

DESCRIPTION:

people grouped collectively or generically by activity, style, or setting.

EXAMPLES:

audience, congregation, citizens, clubbers, beach-goers, spectators, students, guests, fans, coworkers

1.2.1.7 Traits

DESCRIPTION:

adjectives and emotion-based descriptions of an individuals’ qualities or conditions.

EXAMPLES:

aging, anxious, cool, drug addled, gothy, high, mournful, rugged, wise, young, too busy, she has dementia, dead, deceased

1.2.2 [Named Figures]

1.2.2.1 Creators

DESCRIPTION:

real-world individuals known for their creative and artistic authorship — those who shape or originate works rather than perform them.

EXAMPLES:

Alfred Hitchcock, Makoto Shinakai, Baz Luhrman, J.R.R. Tolkien, Jane Austen

1.2.2.2 Fictional Characters

DESCRIPTION:

named characters and non-human entities from stories across literature, film, TV, games, or other narrative media.

EXAMPLES:

Batman, Barbie, Big Bird, Goku, Gordon Freeman, Link, Romeo, Wile E. Coyote, hobbits, Minions, stormtroopers, Seamoth (Subnautica)

1.2.2.3 Historical and Mythical Figures

DESCRIPTION:

named real-world or legendary figures outside contemporary celebrity, including religious and mythological figures.

EXAMPLES:

the Royal Family, Napoleon, Santa Claus, angel Michael, Ba'al, devil

1.2.2.4 Performers and Entertainers

DESCRIPTION:

real-world individuals known for their performance, public presence, or entertainment value across stage, screen, music, or digital platforms.

EXAMPLES:

Audrey Hepburn, Dick Van Dyke, Uma Thurman, Morgan Freeman, David Copperfield, the Rat Pack, Jimmy Fallon, Caroline Girvan

1.2.3 [Social Presence]

DESCRIPTION:

descriptions of how figures are socially situated or configured in relation to others, from states of togetherness to solitude.

1.2.3.1 Solitude

DESCRIPTION:

situations where a figure is explicitly described as alone.

EXAMPLES:

all alone, lone, nobody, solo, themselves, without imagining a person

1.2.3.2 Dyads

DESCRIPTION:

a figure with exactly one other person, whether intimate, familial, adversarial, or situational.

EXAMPLES:

alone with them, next to her, with a friend, with a loved one, with a parent, with my sibling, with the antagonist, with the woman I love

1.2.3.3 Groups

DESCRIPTION:

references to being with multiple people, in familial, social, or public group contexts.

EXAMPLES:

with family, with mates, with a bunch of friends, with a ton of strangers, with people

1.2.4 Body Parts

DESCRIPTION:

literal anatomical references, detached from personality or social identity.

EXAMPLES:

eyes, face, fist, foot, hand, fingers, legs, flesh, brain

1.3 [Objects & Things]

DESCRIPTION:

References to non-living entities, items, and materials — including consumables, built objects, decor, transport, and descriptive qualities, descriptions of objects, and institution-related articles.

1.3.1 Consumables

DESCRIPTION:

edible, drinkable, or intoxicating items for human consumption.

EXAMPLES:

a meal, pasta, popcorn, meatloaf, sugar puffs, candy, ice cream, coffee, soda, tea, beer, wine, whisky, weed, acid, ecstasy, mushrooms, coke

1.3.2 Everyday Objects

DESCRIPTION:

items, furnishings, tools, and entertainment objects commonly found in homes or personal daily environments.

EXAMPLES:

sofa, desk, staircase, toilet, throne, blanket, candles, washing powder, curtains, disco balls, balloons, pinball, puzzles, gun, torch, weights, machinery, phones, artwork, projector, monitors, statue, letters, notes, Newton's cradle, isolation tank, Gravitron

1.3.3 Transport

DESCRIPTION:

all real or imagined modes of transport, including vehicles, vessels, features, and modifications.

EXAMPLES:

muscle car, Ferrari 250 GTO, taxi, truck, motorbike, bicycles, bus, trains, tram, ship, yacht, submarine, biplane, helicopter, rocket, UFO, hovercraft, horse and carriage, slammed, roof down, hydraulics, wipers.

1.3.4 Commerce and Organisations

DESCRIPTION:

entities tied to organisations, commerce, and symbolic representation, including logos, money, corporate identities, and institutional references.

EXAMPLES:

icons, logos, money, product, HMRC phone line, NBA, GEICO, National Trust

1.3.5 Materials and Surfaces

DESCRIPTION:

substances and textures describing what objects are made of and how they feel or appear.

EXAMPLES:

silk, linen, voile, marble, sandstone, cobblestone, chrome, iron, wooden, mirrored, glittery, polished

1.3.6 Object Qualities

DESCRIPTION:

descriptive modifiers of objects, including scale, condition, age, style, prestige, and aesthetic feel.

EXAMPLES:

massive, lots of, old fashioned, dilapidated, art deco, gothic, retro, Victorian, expensive, luxury, majestic, sleek, greasy, jagged, funky, whimsical, strange, weird, cheesy

1.4 [Actions]

DESCRIPTION:

Encompasses all “doing” words—actions, behaviours, process, and motion—by humans and non-humans, including qualifiers and verb modifiers.

1.4.1 [Agentic Actions]

DESCRIPTION:

Purposive, goal-directed behaviours, often propelling narrative development.

1.4.1.1 Directed Movement

DESCRIPTION:

arrival & departure, travel & journeys, walking & roaming, vertical & directional shifts.

EXAMPLES:

leaving, walk, move away, driving to, coming out, showing up,

1.4.1.2 Daily life

DESCRIPTION:

practical, routine, and labour connected to domestic life and work tasks, including physical and mental efforts.

EXAMPLES:

errands, cleaning, vacuuming, putting children to bed, studying, living their day to day, hustling, lifting

1.4.1.3 Music-linked Movement

DESCRIPTION:

physical movement tied to rhythm, musical accompaniment, or expressive bodily response to sound.

EXAMPLES:

dance, boogie, bop, head banging, swaying, rocking out, in the groove, throwing off the shackles, moshing

1.4.1.4 Sports

DESCRIPTION:

physical activities and sport done for fitness, skill, challenge, or play, that is not dance.

EXAMPLES:

aerobics, yoga, hiking, rafting, parkour, surfing

1.4.1.5 Creating and Performing

DESCRIPTION:

artistic, expressive, or intellectual output, including casual and formal creative practices.

EXAMPLES:

jamming, record, rehearsing, drawing, choreographing, inventing

1.4.1.6 Relational and Social

DESCRIPTION:

socially orientated and reciprocal behaviours of communication and engagement.

EXAMPLES:

advice, arguing, chat, cheering, flirting, giving me (from someone), mingling, seduce, speaking, teaching, telling

1.4.1.7 Consuming

DESCRIPTION:

acts of consuming food, drink, or substances including intoxicants and supplements.

EXAMPLES:

eating, sipping, smoking, taking pre-workout

1.4.1.8 Conflict and Wrongdoing

DESCRIPTION:

acts of aggression, violence, deceit, or moral/legal transgression, including physical, verbal, or social harm directed toward people, animals, or property.

EXAMPLES:

abuse, crime, conning, theft, murder, killing, fighting, trickery, harming animals

1.4.2 [Processes and States]

DESCRIPTION:

Attentional, resting, processual, and temporal states of being.

1.4.2.1 Perceptual acts

DESCRIPTION:

one-sided focus, noticing, or gaze-related acts.

EXAMPLES:

gazing, listening, looking, watching, wanted her attention

1.4.2.2 Non-directional Motions

DESCRIPTION:

actions that don't suggest directed movement towards or away from something, but refer to a motion that something or someone does.

EXAMPLES:

drifting, dripping, blowing, floating, flowing,

1.4.2.3 Rest and Leisure

DESCRIPTION:

physical postures, states of inactivity, relaxation, or low-effort enjoyment, including both stillness and casual recreation.

EXAMPLES:

drifting off, in my chair, lay, lounging, seated, standing, bent over, upside down, waking up, taking a nap, gaming, shopping, clubbing, cruising, browsing

1.4.2.4 Transforming and Learning

DESCRIPTION:

processes of change, development, or adaptation, whether physical, emotional, cognitive, or symbolic.

EXAMPLES:

breakthrough (knowledge), discovered, integrate, learn, pursue (learning), reclaiming, solving, trying to (...), turning into, melting, exploding, malfunctioning

1.4.2.5 Waiting and Anticipating

DESCRIPTION:

activities that involve readiness, expectation, or delay before an action or event.

EXAMPLES:

getting ready, awaiting, anticipating

1.4.3 [Action Modifiers]

DESCRIPTION:

Adverbs that qualify and recalibrate scene animation.

1.4.3.1 Speed

DESCRIPTION:

references to how fast or slow an action or motion occurs.

EXAMPLES:

quickly, slowly, hurriedly, instantly, sluggishly

1.4.3.2 Characterisation

DESCRIPTION:

qualities describing the specific character or manner of a movement, often reflecting personality or attitude.

EXAMPLES:

confidently, gracefully, casually, flamboyantly, aggressively, angrily, joyfully, playfully, sadly

2 REFERENTIAL

2.1 [Music & Sounds]

DESCRIPTION:

References to music, sound, and auditory experience — spanning instruments, creators, playback, qualities, functions, and non-musical sound events.

2.1.1 Instruments, Ensembles, and Imitations

DESCRIPTION:

physical instruments, parts and accessories, voice types, musical groups, and pretend playing of instruments.

EXAMPLES:

saxophone, drums, theremin, orchestra, marching band, choir, duet, singer, vocalist, a cappella, bow, brushes, baton, pedals, MIDI, air guitar, pretending to play drums

2.1.2 Music Use and Function**DESCRIPTION:**

contexts, purposes, and effects of music in daily life, ritual, commerce, or symbolic use.

EXAMPLES:

before going to sleep, song for chores, start my day, for the soul, get out of the sad feeling, to try to quit smoking, helps me relax, gets you pumped, useful for deep thinking, to maintain a buzz, for a love, sending a message, meant to distract fans from misery, sell a product, music makes unpleasant things tolerable, leading to a looser pocket, to keep you in a trance, usually signal marching

2.1.3 Sound Qualities**DESCRIPTION:**

descriptions of how music or sound feels, is judged, or conveys mood, energy, or aesthetic character.

EXAMPLES:

well known, biggest hit, calming, soothing, melancholic, spooky, uplifting, celebratory, dramatic, whimsical, upbeat, energetic, lively, bouncy

2.1.3.1 Music Genre, Cultural, and Stylistic Labels**DESCRIPTION:**

named categories, stylistic markers, or cultural associations used to classify music.

EXAMPLES:

RnB, jazz, EDM, disco, metal, house, lo-fi, funk, new wave, old-school, grungy, indie, jazzy, funky, African, Arabic, Jewish, Scandi, Karaoke song, Hold music, Elevator music

2.1.3.2 Technical and Structural Music Elements**DESCRIPTION:**

references to compositional, rhythmic, or performance-based aspects of sound arrangement.

EXAMPLES:

driving beat, beat drop, crescendo, tempo builds up, modulated, distorted, repetitive, improvising, instrumental section, intro (referring to music)

2.1.4 Playback and Listening Devices**DESCRIPTION:**

devices and media formats through which music and sound are stored, transmitted, and heard.

EXAMPLES:

cassettes, tape, records, vinyl, CDs, boombox, console stereo, jukebox, gramophone, car radio, radio station, channels, Hi-Fi, amps, headphones, earphone

2.1.5 Named Artists and Musicians**DESCRIPTION:**

specific musicians, composers, singers, bands, or collectives.

EXAMPLES:

Nina Simone, Prince, Linkin Park, Debussy, Tchaikovsky, Stranvinsky, Avicii, Delia Derbyshire, Ol' Blue Eyes (Frank Sinatra stage name), the Rat Pack

2.1.6 Named Songs and Lyrics**DESCRIPTION:**

named songs, lyric fragments, and explicit reference to song text.

EXAMPLES:

Sweet Dreams, Enter Sandman, Take On Me, The Girl From Ipanema, "sweet dreams are made of this", "blue Christmas without you", "shock me like an electric eel"

2.1.7 Sounds and Sound Effects**DESCRIPTION:**

non-musical auditory events, environmental noises, voices, or sound effects.

EXAMPLES:

barking, chirping, jungle noises, footsteps, rustling, beeping, sirens, foghorn, revving, alarm, ringtone,

games console startup, boom, pow, crash, clomping, pounding, blasting, laughter, growl, deep voice, religious chanting, sound effects, special effects, commotion, noises, silence

2.2 [Media, Art, & Technology]

DESCRIPTION:

References to any type of media, artistic, entertainment, and technological domains — including formats, platforms, works, and techniques.

2.2.1 Media Formats

DESCRIPTION:

classifications of media by delivery format.

EXAMPLES:

musical, sitcom, talk show, advert, TV, documentary, news broadcast, RPG, MMO, side-scroller, arcade, music video, instructional video, pixel art, anime, bad graphics, VHS, comic book, video tape, anime art style, storyboard

2.2.2 Media Genres and Styles

DESCRIPTION:

classifications of media by genre, aesthetic, or stylistic labels.

EXAMPLES:

Bollywood, thriller, romance, comedy, blockbuster, period piece/drama, silent film, detective show, children's TV, soap opera, RPG, MMO, side-scroller, arcade, racing, boss fight, pixel art, anime, black-and-white, bad graphics, feel-good, gritty, cheesy, tacky, iconic, old-fashioned, black-and-white storyboard

2.2.3 Media Packaging Structures

DESCRIPTION:

paratextual framing and structural devices used in the presentation of stories or media, especially framing and transitional elements.

EXAMPLES:

opening credits, intro sequence, cliffhanger, outro, plot, cutscenes, montage, "behind the scenes", titles

2.2.4 Media Techniques and Effects

DESCRIPTION:

production and presentation methods, including camera work, editing styles, and visual effects.

EXAMPLES:

close-up, wide shot, panning, fade-out, green screen, CGI, drone shots, panoramic, sped up, film grain, reveal, sweeping shots

2.2.5 Music and Sound in Media

DESCRIPTION:

audio elements in media, including soundtracks, diegetic sound, and narrative voice.

EXAMPLES:

soundtrack, OST, theme tune, TV intro music, boss fight music, montage track, monologues, narration, voiceover, no dialogue

2.2.6 Media Companies and Devices

DESCRIPTION:

named corporations, studios, publishers, brands, streaming services, and hardware associated with media production and consumption.

EXAMPLES:

Disney, Pixar, Hasbro, Sierra, Atari, Sega, Nintendo, Warner Bros, Casio, DS, PlayStation, Wii, SNES, Commodore 64, game console, Spotify, CRT TV, HD TV, television set, VR headset

2.2.7 Digital Platforms and Applications

DESCRIPTION:

online environments, apps, and technological tools for digital communications, creativity, or AI-mediated interaction.

EXAMPLES:

apps, Mindful (app), Music Maker JAM, meditation apps, gif, meme, FMV meme, Instagram, TikTok, YouTube, see this a lot on socials, AI-generated, Alexa (voice-command speaker)

2.2.8 Named Media References

DESCRIPTION:

explicit references to specific works, titles, franchises, or recognisable elements such as quotes, objects, and settings from media works.

EXAMPLES:

Blade Runner, Star Wars, Sesame Street, BBC-Proms, Stranger Things, Zelda, Animal Crossing, Minecraft, Dune, Les Misérables, Swan Lake, Dungeons & Dragons, Warhammer 4K, "A long time ago in a galaxy far, far away...", Gotham, Naboo, the Shire, Namek, holodeck, Super Saiyan, League Pass (NBA live TV)

2.3 [Chronology & Events]

DESCRIPTION:

References to time, temporality, and happenings — from the scale of daily markers to major historical events and narrative structures.

2.3.1 Events and Occasions

DESCRIPTION:

specific gatherings, ceremonies, specific gatherings, ceremonies, rituals, or social happenings that mark an event in time.

EXAMPLES:

party, wedding, funeral, concert, festival, sports match, theatre show, parade, dates, class, exam, therapy session, graduation, religious ceremony, disco, or social happenings that mark an event in time.

2.3.2 Historical Events and Periods

DESCRIPTION:

large-scale eras, decades, centuries, or significant historical moments with cultural identity or context.

EXAMPLES:

1920s, Renaissance, Swinging Sixties, wartime, golden age, prohibition, 1700s, 20th century, "back in the day," Vietnam War, World Wars, ancient times, early-2000s

2.3.3 Narrative Progression

DESCRIPTION:

thematic and emotional beats that chart the unfolding of a story (fictional or lived), including shifts, climaxes, and resolutions.

EXAMPLES:

beginnings, endings, climax build-ups, pivotal scenes, tragic moments, triumph, loss, revelations, realisations, impending doom, heartbreak

2.3.4 Passage and Repetition of Time

DESCRIPTION:

references to duration, frequency, recurrence, and passing of time, including endurance and time-travel notions.

EXAMPLES:

all day, all night, every single time, seen it so many times, plays everyday, a million times, few days ago, years ago, passing time, timer set, time travelling

2.3.5 Seasons and Time

DESCRIPTION:

temporal markers within daily cycles, seasonal rhythms, and holidays as reference-points.

EXAMPLES:

morning, afternoon, night, midnight, dusk, dawn, twilight, bedtime, after work, after school, 3am, Christmas, Halloween, Autumn, Winter, weekend

3 EXPERIENTIAL

3.1 [Symbolic & Sensory Representations]

DESCRIPTION:

Abstract, figurative, and sensory (real or imagined) dimensions of experience — spanning metaphors, values, and perceptual details.

3.1.1 [Sensory Details]

DESCRIPTION:

Perceptual and bodily details describing how things are sensed — either literally or imaginatively.

3.1.1.1 [Visual Details]

3.1.1.1.1 Colour

DESCRIPTION:

direct references to colours or palettes.

EXAMPLES:

amber, neon, muted, black & white

3.1.1.1.2 Illumination

DESCRIPTION:

descriptions of brightness, lighting, or visual effects created by illumination sources and their absence.

EXAMPLES:

glow, spotlights, candlelit, lasers, strobe, moonlight, total darkness

3.1.1.1.3 Text

DESCRIPTION:

written or projected words, quotes, or symbolic text as a visible element.

EXAMPLES:

text on screen, words, titles, quotes, projected text

3.1.1.1.4 Vantage Point

DESCRIPTION:

perspective or focal orientation of the viewer or scene.

EXAMPLES:

the focus is on, aerial view, vantage point, up close, everywhere you look

3.1.1.1.5 Oddities, Effects, Shapes, Patterns

DESCRIPTION:

stylised or abstract visual phenomena, unusual imagery, illusions, and motion patterns.

EXAMPLES:

fractals, kaleidoscope, swirls, shapes, patterns, waves, cascade, checkerboard, psychedelic visuals, blurry images, reflections, pixelations, mechanical imagery, (any other abstract description like saxophones blowing bubbles or abstract bouncing silver discs, for example)

3.1.1.2 Smell

DESCRIPTION:

odours, scents, and aromatic qualities that set an atmosphere.

EXAMPLES:

incense, scent, smoky, fills the air, I can smell the ...

3.1.1.3 Bodily Sensation

DESCRIPTION:

physical sensations and tactile experiences, both external and visceral.

EXAMPLES:

warm, cold, breeze, goosebumps, heartbeat, sun on face, wet, damp, hair blowing in the wind, tremors

3.1.2 Conceptual and Metaphorical References

DESCRIPTION:

symbolic ideas, cultural and ideological abstractions, and metaphorical frames of meaning.

EXAMPLES:

aesthetics, divinity, escapism, faith, harmony, health, holiday spirit, hope, lifestyle, love/love lost, magic, rage, rock culture, romance, subliminal messages, vibes, violence, itchy trigger fingers, up to their ankles in ..., hellfire, fire and brimstone

3.2 [Subjective & Personal Experience]

DESCRIPTION:

How people react to, evaluate, and connect with music in terms of personal feelings, opinions, and meaningful links to people and times in their life.

3.2.1 Emotions and Affective States

DESCRIPTION:

immediate emotional or mood-based states described in vivo, often affectively coloured words or phrases.

EXAMPLES:

anxious, calm, nostalgic, angry, peaceful, in awe, in love, "that feeling you have", "flooded" (with emotion), calming thoughts, eerie, suspenseful, uplifting, oppressive, soothing, bittersweet, cozy, unsettling

3.2.2 Opinions and Preferences

DESCRIPTION:

judgments, likes and dislikes, and other taste-related stances evaluating the music itself.

EXAMPLES:

I liked/loved/hated, not my cup of tea, fan of, favourite song, "not music", spoiled it, good, great, awful, boring, pleasant, not appealing, wouldn't bother (listening), put up with it, inspires nothing, wanted it to end quickly, loved this band, saves the clip

3.2.3 Personal Significance

DESCRIPTION:

references where music takes on a symbolic, identity-based, relational, or spiritual meaning beyond immediate enjoyment.

EXAMPLES:

reminds me of her, my happy place, connected to, meaningful to me, our family piano, all praise to God, RIP, things get better, trying to find my way, your favourite song is on its way

3.2.4 Personal Time-linked Connections

DESCRIPTION:

connections where music is explicitly tied to life stages, personal memories, and other temporally anchored experiences.

EXAMPLES:

childhood, teenage years, when I was young, at 10 years old, first concert, my club days, "my mom is alive", "things will never be as they were", took me back, lazy days, "reclaiming the peace you had before"